Hope Hospital Creation Date 01/01/2017 Released Date 11/01/2017 Reviewed On :- 16/01/2023 Reviewed On :- 15/01/2025	**Guidelines on Near-Expiry Medications**	
	Version: 3.0	
	Created by Quality Coordinator Signature/Name: Dr. Darpan Jakkal,	**Guidance and Approved by Director** Signature/Name: Dr. B K Murali

1. Purpose

To establish a standard process for identification, tracking, and appropriate action related to near-expiry medications to ensure patient safety, minimize wastage, and maintain regulatory compliance.

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2. Scope

Applies to all departments involved in the procurement, storage, and dispensing of medications, especially the **pharmacy**, **stores**, and **clinical units**.

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3. Definition

Near-expiry medication: Any medication that is within **3 to 6 months** of its expiry date (or as defined by hospital policy).

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4. Guidelines

A. Identification and Monitoring

- The pharmacy shall maintain a system (manual or digital) to **flag and track** near-expiry medications regularly.
- Conduct **monthly audits** of stock in all pharmacy and clinical storage areas.
- Maintain a **"Near-Expiry Drug List"** with batch number, expiry date, and quantity.

B. Labeling and Segregation

- Clearly **label near-expiry medicines** with color-coded tags (e.g., yellow for 3 months, red for 1 month).
- Segregate near-expiry medications physically within the pharmacy/store.

C. Utilization and Redistribution

- Prioritize dispensing of near-expiry drugs using **FEFO (First Expiry First Out)** system.
- If usage is unlikely before expiry, **redistribute** within the hospital to units where the medicine is likely to be consumed sooner.
- Avoid issuing near-expiry drugs for **long-term prescriptions** unless confirmed by the prescriber and patient.

D. Return to Supplier (if applicable)

- Coordinate with suppliers for return or replacement of near-expiry stock as per contractual terms.
- Ensure proper documentation of return process.

E. Disposal

- If medications remain unused past expiry, dispose of them safely following the **Bio-medical Waste Management Rules**, and record in the **Drug Disposal Register**.

F. Documentation

- Maintain records for:
    - Near-expiry drug identification
    - Inter-departmental transfers
    - Returns to vendor
    - Disposal (with batch, quantity, and method)

5. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Pharmacist	Identify, segregate, label, and report near-expiry stock
Store Officer	Track and flag medicines nearing expiry in central inventory
Nursing Staff	Notify pharmacy if they identify near-expiry drugs in ward stock
Purchase/Procurement	Coordinate returns or replacements with vendors
Quality Department	Audit compliance and track trends for corrective action

6. Training and Awareness

- Conduct periodic training for pharmacy and nursing staff on identifying and managing near-expiry stock.
- Display posters/reminders about near-expiry monitoring in pharmacy and storage areas.